# Interface Design IDEA9105

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The goal of this design solution is to support anxious karaoke users before public song selection in group settings. Primary and background research suggested that users often feel overwhelmed by too many song options and uncertain about what feels familiar, manageable, or lower-pressure to sing in front of others. Based on this, the smartwatch concept focuses on the following high-level functions:

- Browse one suggested song at a time
- Review short reasons to understand why a song may feel more manageable
- Save and compare lower-pressure song options before confirming the best fit

These functions respond to the need for a quicker and lower-pressure decision process at a stressful moment in the karaoke experience. Rather than replacing the main KTV song-search interface, the concept creates a more private and supportive pre-selection step before a final public decision is made. The smartwatch was selected because it provides a lightweight, private, and low-friction form of support during a socially stressful moment (Dobson et al., 2023).

**Insights from Primary Research**

Primary research revealed that karaoke anxiety is shaped not only by singing ability, but also by the emotional risk of participating in front of others. This suggests a need for lower-pressure support during song choice in group settings.

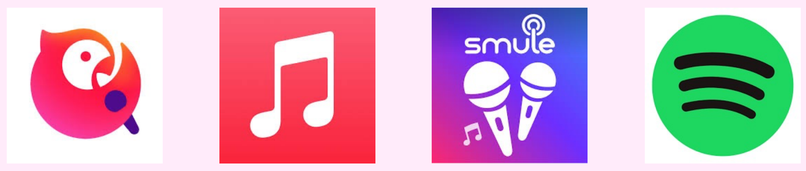
It also showed that anxiety is influenced by social context, including who is present and whether the atmosphere feels supportive or judgmental, which is consistent with research showing that social support is significantly related to music performance anxiety (Zhang & Salarzadeh Jenatabadi, 2024).

**Competitor Analysis**

This analysis focused on two categories of competitors: karaoke platforms and music discovery platforms. This was because the proposed concept addresses song choice in karaoke settings, while also drawing on existing models of recommendation, browsing, saving, and confidence-building support. Direct karaoke-related competitors such as Smule and Quanmin K Ge were analysed to understand socially visible singing, participation, and song-choice pressure. Music discovery competitors such as Spotify and Apple Music were analysed to understand recommendation systems, queue or library management, and ways of narrowing down music choices. Some of the factors specifically examined were:

1. Song search and recommendation flows
2. Save-for-later and shortlist behaviours
3. Confidence-building cues such as familiarity, lyrics, and manageable song options
4. Areas that do not directly address karaoke anxiety or socially pressured song choice

More detailed findings are included in the appendix.



(Apple App Store, 2026)

**Insights**

Current karaoke platforms provide strong references for song participation, duet or group interaction, and socially visible singing, but they are often more performance-focused than lower-pressure decision-support focused.

Music discovery platforms such as Spotify and Apple Music show how recommendation, search, saved content, and queue-like behaviours can help narrow choices, but they are not designed to support karaoke anxiety or group song-choice pressure directly.

Across all four competitors, no single platform directly supports anxious users before public karaoke song selection, which suggests an opportunity for a more focused pre-selection experience that helps users browse, review, save, and confirm more manageable song options.

**First Iteration hand-drawn sketches (Ideation Phase)**

For the first stage of ideation, I explored a range of possible smartwatch layouts for each key step of the song-support flow. Rather than refining one idea too early, I tested different interaction patterns to understand how recommendation, saving, comparison, and confirmation could work on a small wearable screen. This stage was useful for visualising multiple directions quickly and identifying which layouts felt too abstract, too crowded, or less suitable for a low-pressure karaoke support experience.




1.Opening question shows the user's uncertainty before choosing.
2.Large button creates a clear starting point.But "Start support" seems a help center.



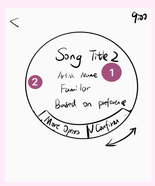

1.Central question makes the choice feel easier.
2.Options help users narrow songs by safer directions.
3.But the design and text descriptions are not clear enough in explaining the icons.




1.One song at a time reduces clutter.
2.The interface is not clear enough, and the text descriptions are not consistent.




1.The card song design can roughly explain the design intent.
2.The design is too complex and lacks consistency.




1 Selected song becomes the main focus.
2.The design is too simple.

**Second Iteration hand-drawn sketches (LoFi wireframes)**

The next step was to develop the most promising sketches into more focused and usable low-fidelity wireframes. In this stage, the layouts became more structured, the hierarchy between information and actions became clearer, and each screen moved closer to a more realistic smartwatch interface. Compared with the earlier ideation sketches, these versions reduced unnecessary complexity and established a more consistent design language across the overall flow.




1.Room and queue information makes the screen feel more connected to a karaoke session.
2.The main button gives users one clear action to begin.



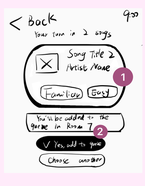

1.Stacked cards make the options easier to scan on a small screen.
2.The question focuses on what feels easier, rather than asking users to search directly.




1. One song card reduces clutter and keeps attention on one option.
2.The reason section explains why the song may feel manageable.

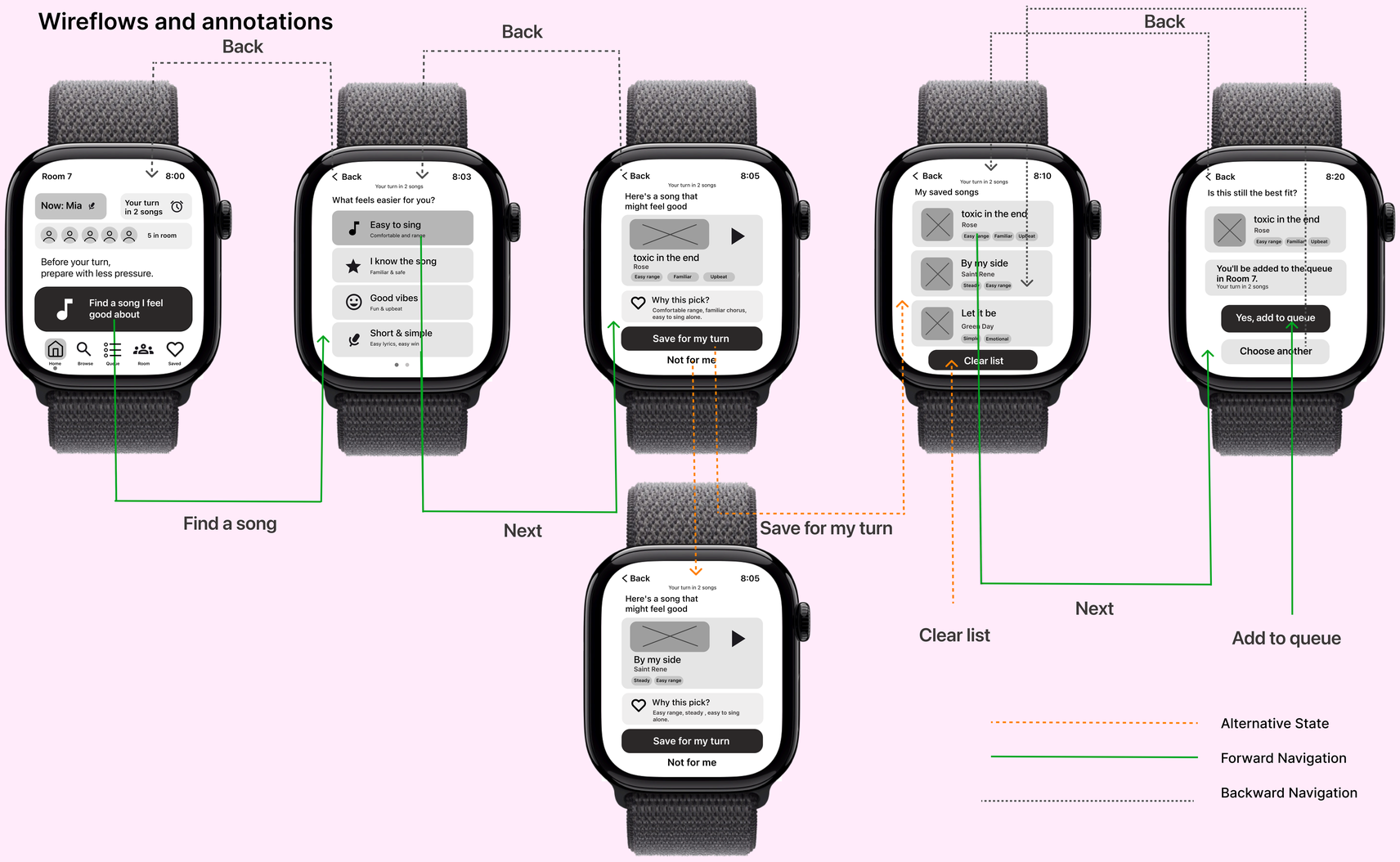



1.Tags help users compare songs through simple cues.
2.Clear list gives users a way to reset if the shortlist feels wrong.




1.The selected song is shown clearly before the final action.
2.Queue information connects the private watch flow to the shared karaoke room.

## Wireflows and annotations




## Home

This screen works as a clearer app entry instead of an alert-like start.
Room, turn, and group context make it feel like part of a karaoke system rather than a standalone song tool.
The main button gives users a calmer and more direct way to begin before their turn.

## What feels easier?

This screen helps users start with simple guided choices instead of relying on memory or immediate search.
The stacked card layout is easier to scan on a smartwatch and reduces decision pressure.
Short labels and icons make the starting options feel more approachable.

## Recommendation

This screen shows one song at a time to keep the decision focused and manageable.
A short reason explains why the song may feel easier to sing in a karaoke setting.
Separating the main song from the secondary action helps users move forward without feeling overwhelmed.

## Saved songs

This screen brings saved options together so users can compare them privately before joining the queue.
The repeated card structure keeps the shortlist easy to review on a small screen.
This step separates comparison from final confirmation, which makes the process feel more controlled.

## Confirm best fit

This screen presents one final choice clearly before the song is added to the queue.
Queue-related context makes the action feel connected to the larger karaoke session.
The clear primary action supports commitment, while the secondary action keeps the decision flexible.

# References


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Tencent Music Entertainment Hong Kong Limited. (n.d.). 全民*K*歌-你其实很会唱歌 [Mobile app]. App Store. Retrieved April 20, 2026, from https://apps.apple.com/cn/app/%E5%85%A8%E6%B0%91k%E6%AD%8C-%E4%BD%A0%E5%85%B6%E5%AE%9E%E5%BE%88%E4%BC%9A%E5%94%B1%E6%AD%8C/id910513149

Zhang, H., & Salarzadeh Jenatabadi, H. (2024). Effects of social support on music performance anxiety among university music students: Chain mediation of emotional intelligence and self-efficacy. *Frontiers in Psychology, 15*, 1389681. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2024.1389681


# Appendix

### Competitor Analysis Findings

| Category | Smule | Spotify | Apple Music | Quanmin K Ge |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Functionality** | Smule is a karaoke and social singing platform that lets users browse a large song library, sing solo or with others, record performances, and share them with a wider community. It supports scrolling lyrics, duet singing, group participation, and live karaoke interaction, making it useful for understanding socially visible singing, lower-barrier participation, and karaoke-specific performance flows. | Spotify is a music streaming platform that lets users search for songs, artists, albums, playlists, genres, and moods, browse personalised recommendations, save content, and manage what plays next through the queue. It is useful for analysing search, autocomplete, recommendation, and queue-based browsing behaviours. | Apple Music is a music streaming platform that supports song search, lyric search, recommendations, playlists, saved libraries, and queue management. It is also relevant because Apple Music Sing provides time-synced lyrics and vocal control, making it useful for understanding music discovery, browsing support, and sing-along features that sit close to karaoke behaviour. | Quanmin K Ge is a karaoke and singing-social platform that allows users to search songs, sing with karaoke backing tracks, record performances, use lyric-based interfaces, and share or interact with others through song rooms, duet formats, and other social features. It is useful for understanding karaoke participation, song selection, social pressure, and performance-oriented interaction. |
| **Key activities** | • Browse and search for songs<br>• Sing solo or duet with others<br>• Record karaoke performances<br>• Share performances with the community<br>• Join live karaoke or group singing participation | • Search for songs, artists, playlists, genres, and moods<br>• Use autocomplete and search suggestions<br>• Browse personalised recommendations<br>• Save songs to library or playlists<br>• Manage what plays next through the queue | • Search by title, artist, lyrics, or library content<br>• Browse recommendations, playlists, and saved music<br>• View lyrics while listening<br>• Save songs to the library or playlists<br>• Use queue and playback controls to manage listening | • Search and browse karaoke songs<br>• Sing and record solo performances<br>• Join duet or group singing activities<br>• Share performances and interact socially<br>• Use karaoke-specific lyrics and audio support |
| **Focus / Goal** | The main goal of Smule is to make singing participatory, social, and creative. It encourages users to sing with others, practise, perform, and engage with a wider karaoke community, while also allowing more private practice through solo recording options. | The main goal of Spotify is to make music discovery and listening fast, personalised, and easy to manage. It supports users in finding relevant content efficiently while organising future listening through saved content and queue controls. | The main goal of Apple Music is to support music discovery, library management, and listening through a streamlined, content-rich ecosystem. Features such as lyrics and Apple Music Sing also support sing-along behaviour, making it useful for analysing confidence-building support around familiar songs and guided browsing. | The main goal of Quanmin K Ge is to support singing, recording, and music-centred social interaction. It encourages users to choose songs, perform, share, and join karaoke-related participation in ways that are strongly tied to public and semi-public singing culture. |
| **Strengths** | • Strong social and participatory singing model<br>• Clear karaoke and performance context<br>• Useful reference for how singing products encourage engagement<br>• Provides examples of duet and lower-barrier participation formats<br>• Large song library with scrolling lyrics supports karaoke-specific interaction | • Strong search and autocomplete support<br>• Clear recommendation and discovery system<br>• Useful reference for queue-based song browsing<br>• Helps reduce decision load through personalised suggestions and structured search tools<br>• Supports multiple ways to find content, including lyric search | • Strong search, library, and playlist organisation<br>• Lyrics support helps connect music discovery with sing-along use<br>• Apple Music Sing is relevant to karaoke-adjacent participation<br>• Clear recommendations help narrow choice<br>• Useful reference for balancing discovery, saved content, and confidence-building familiarity | • Strong karaoke-specific context<br>• Large licensed song library and lyric-led singing experience<br>• Useful reference for socially visible singing and performance sharing<br>• Provides examples of duet, room-based, and group participation formats<br>• Strong relevance to song-choice pressure in karaoke culture |
| **Weaknesses** | • More performance-focused than lower-pressure decision-support focused<br>• Social exposure may still feel intimidating for anxious users<br>• Does not specifically address song-choice anxiety in group settings<br>• Many features may feel overwhelming for users who want a simpler song-selection process | • Built for general music listening rather than karaoke-specific needs<br>• Can still present many choices and categories at once<br>• Does not directly address socially pressured song choice or anxiety<br>• Not specifically designed for group karaoke decision-making<br>• Recommendation logic may not always support safe or confidence-building song choice | • Built for general listening rather than karaoke-specific group decision-making<br>• Can still present many options at once<br>• Lyrics and sing-along features do not directly solve song-choice anxiety<br>• Not specifically designed for socially pressured karaoke selection<br>• Recommendations are not always framed around confidence or low-pressure choice | • Strong focus on public performance may increase pressure for anxious users<br>• More performance- and sharing-focused than decision-support focused<br>• Many social and entertainment features may feel overwhelming<br>• Does not specifically support lower-pressure pre-selection before group choice<br>• Interaction can feel broad and feature-heavy for users who want a simpler decision flow |

# Some more sketches

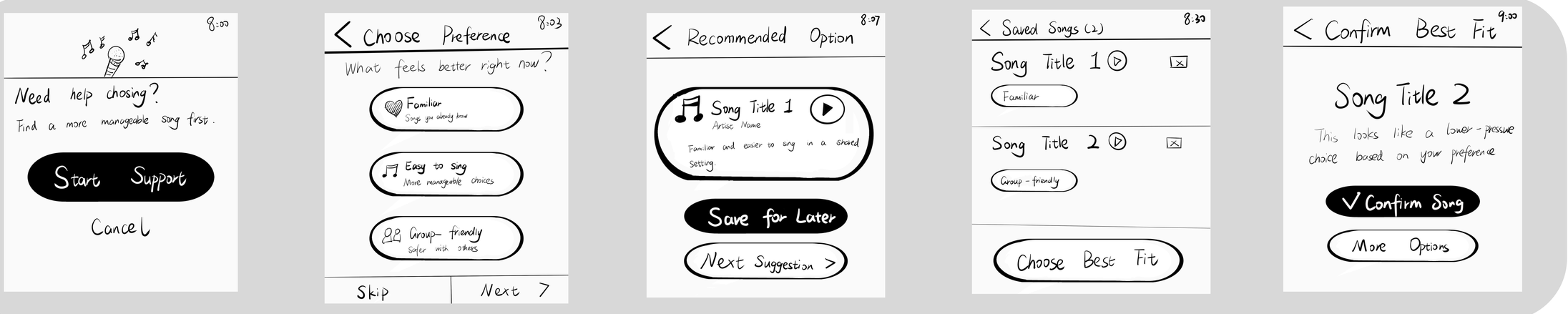
## Iteration 1




**Overall comments/thoughts:**

- The screens are beginning to take the form of an initial interface, but some pages still appear too text-heavy for a smartwatch
- The recommendation feature, saved songs, and confirmation step are starting to work together, but the connections between them could still be clearer
- Some button labels are still not precise enough in explaining the intended action
- The layout is becoming more structured, but the overall system still needs stronger consistency in wording, navigation, and information hierarchy

## Iteration 2




**Overall comments/thoughts:**

- The second iteration feels more structured, and the overall flow across the five screens is much clearer
- The card-based layouts make the actions easier to recognise, but some screens still feel slightly busy for a smartwatch
- The recommendation and saved songs screens communicate the process better, though the buttons and labels could still be simplified further
- The system is becoming more consistent, but navigation, wording, and spacing could still be refined to make the experience feel smoother

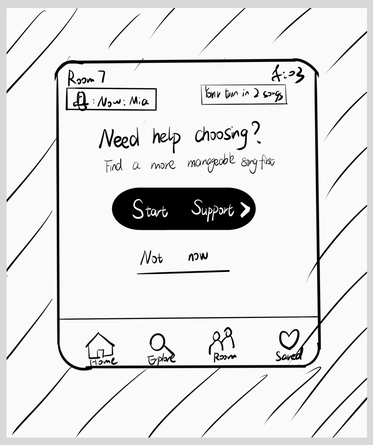
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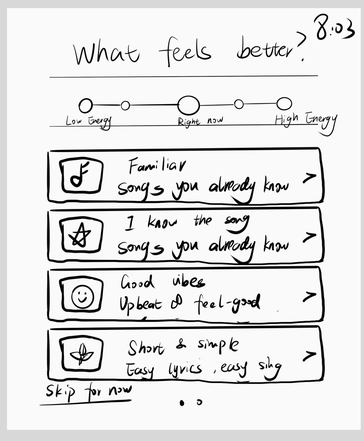



**Overall comments/thoughts:**

- This iteration explores more playful and visually distinct layouts, but some screens start to feel too conceptual for a quick smartwatch interaction
- The circular structures create a stronger focal point, although they may make scanning and decision-making less direct
- The saved songs and recommendation screens show more variation in layout, but the relationship between information and action is still not always clear
- This version is visually interesting, but the overall system may need to become simpler and more consistent to feel practical on a smartwatch

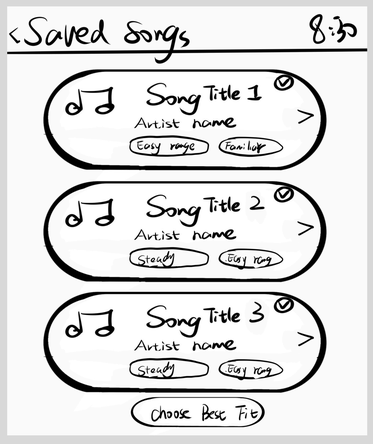
## Iteration 4

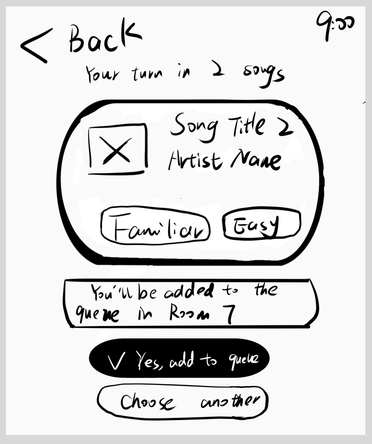









**Overall comments/thoughts:**

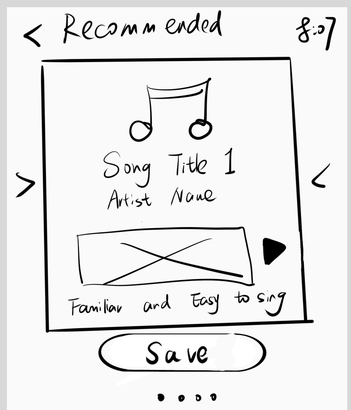
- This iteration became more interface-like and easier to follow, with clearer screen roles across the whole flow
- The home screen started to show stronger karaoke context through room, queue, and bottom navigation elements
- The recommendation and saved songs screens became more practical, but some areas still looked slightly crowded for a smartwatch
- The confirmation screen began to connect the private song choice with the shared karaoke queue, but the hierarchy still needed refinement

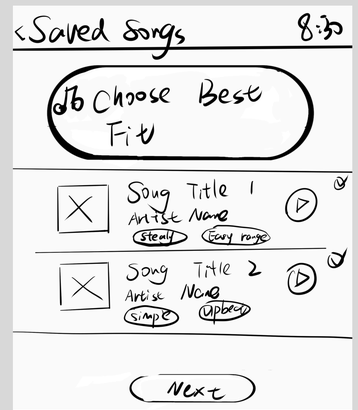
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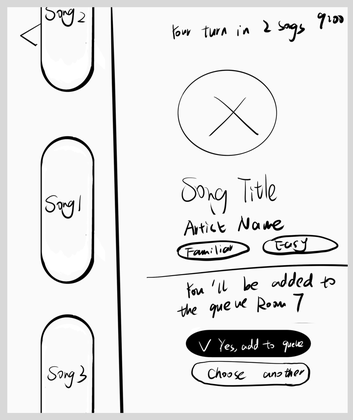








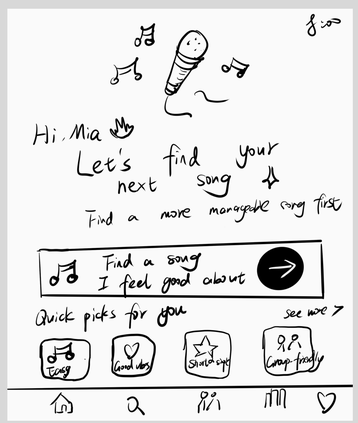



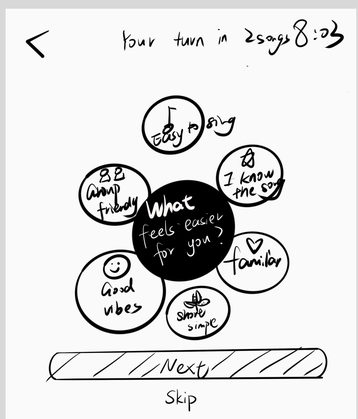



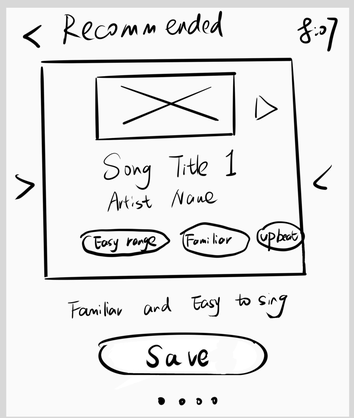

**Overall comments/thoughts:**

- This iteration explored bolder layouts and stronger visual variation, especially in the recommendation and confirmation screens
- The flow showed clearer decision support by separating recommendation, saved review, and final confirmation
- Some experimental layouts made the system feel more playful, but they also reduced consistency across screens
- The final direction needed to keep the useful queue context while simplifying the interaction for quicker smartwatch use

## Iteration 6

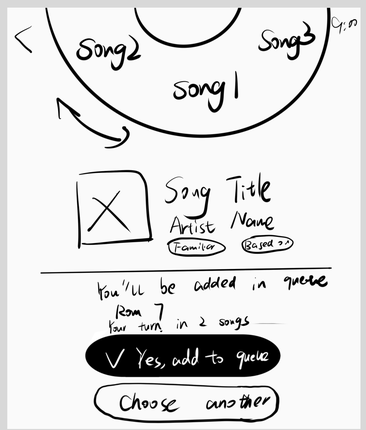




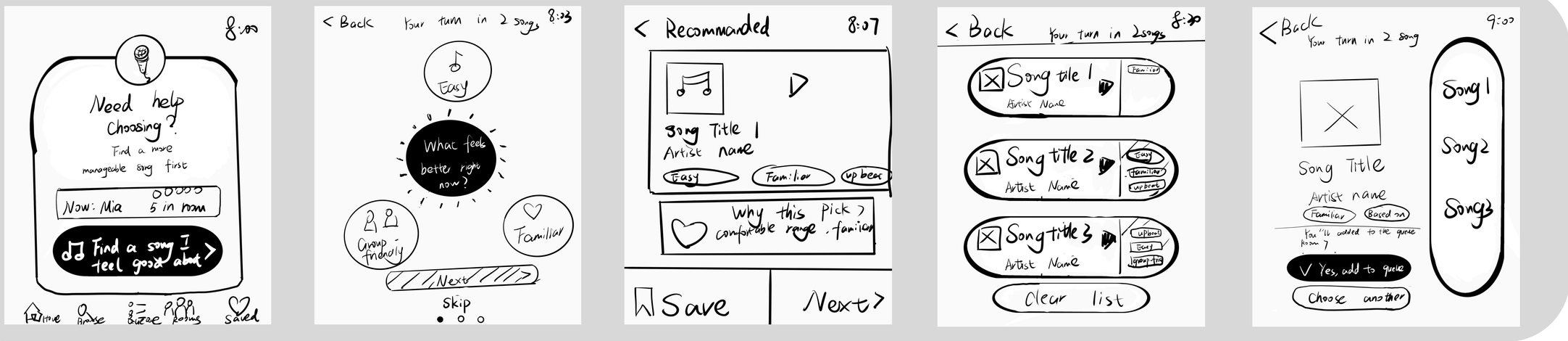





**Overall comments/thoughts:**

- This iteration tested more alternative layouts, including side lists and stronger visual separation between song options
- The screens explored different ways to compare and confirm songs, but some layouts still felt too complex for a small wearable interface
- The saved songs and confirmation screens showed useful ideas for review and final decision-making, but the navigation still needed to be more direct
- The final design should combine the clearest elements from this version with a simpler, more consistent smartwatch layout

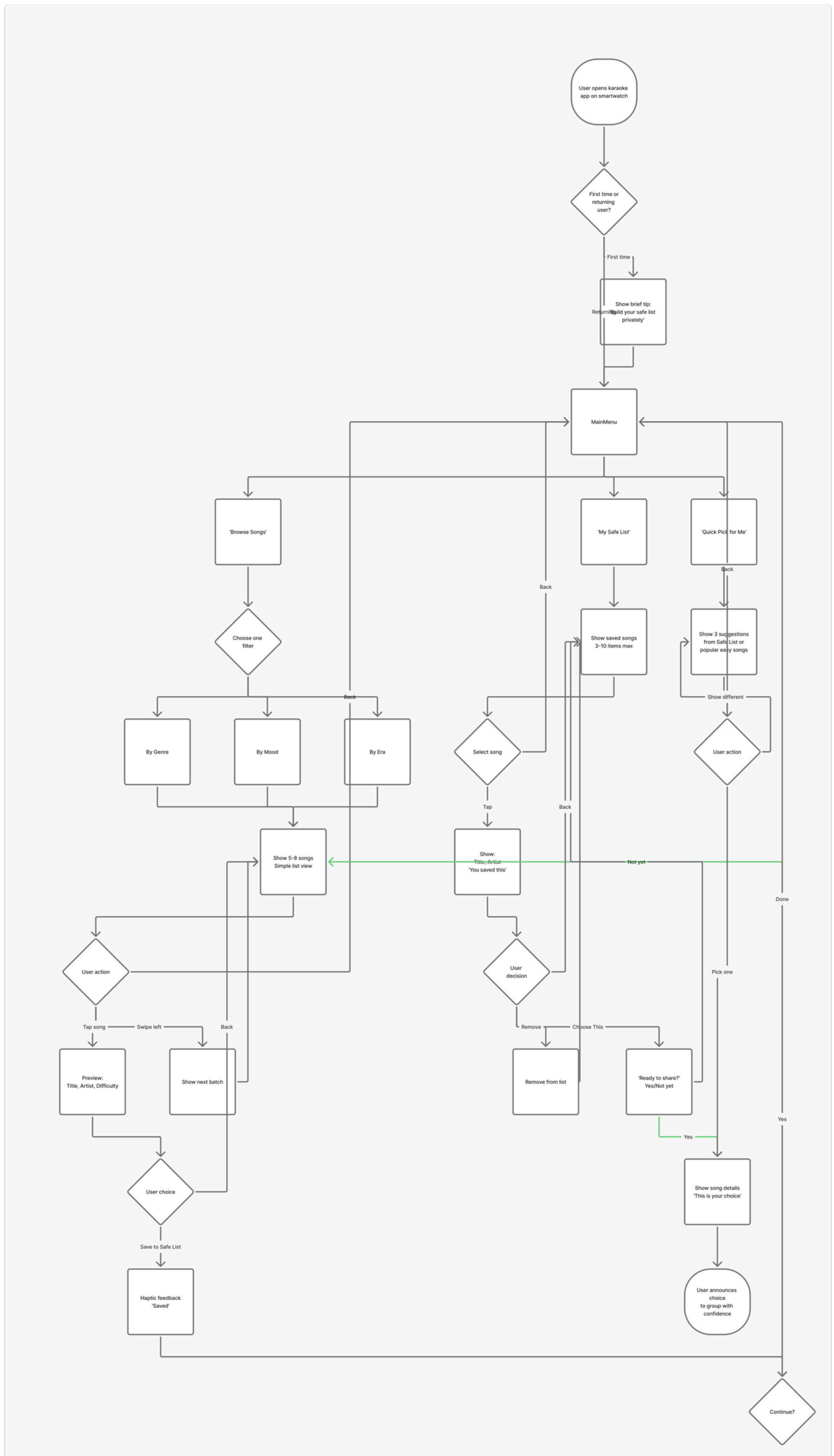
### Iteration 7




**Overall comments/thoughts:**

- This final sketch iteration is closest to the final digital wireflow, but the wording, spacing, and visual style still need to be more consistent across the whole system
- The overall design should become more card-based, so song information, feedback, and actions can follow a similar structure across the home, recommendation, saved songs, and confirmation screens
- The preference / filtering screen should be more direct and less decorative, helping users quickly choose what feels easier without adding extra visual complexity
- The confirmation screen should be simpler and more straightforward, focusing on one selected song, queue context, and one clear action before the song is added to the shared karaoke queue

## User Flow/AI Generation




**Prompt**

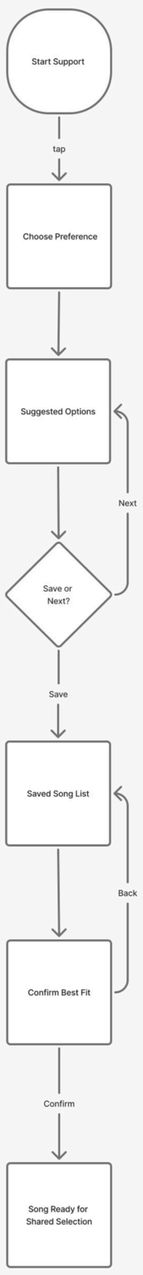
**Objective**
Support anxious karaoke users in group settings by reducing pressure during song choice and helping them feel more confident before making one final decision.

**User details**
Users may feel anxious when choosing a song in front of others. They may worry about choosing the wrong song, being judged, or drawing unwanted attention. They need a quicker, more private, and lower-pressure way to narrow down a few familiar, manageable, and lower-pressure song options before making a final choice.

**Design guidelines**
The flow should be simple, low-fidelity, and suitable for a smartwatch. It should keep information minimal, use clear hierarchy, and focus on reducing cognitive load. Interactions should support short, private, and low-pressure steps for narrowing down, saving, and reviewing options rather than complex browsing, detailed exploration, or immediate commitment. The concept should work as a lightweight private support tool, not a full karaoke browsing app.

**User details**
Create a simple smartwatch user flow for anxious karaoke users in group settings who feel pressure when choosing a song in front of others. The flow should work as a lightweight private support tool that helps users quickly narrow down a few familiar, manageable, and lower-pressure song options, save safer choices, and feel more confident before making one final decision. Keep the interaction low-fidelity, minimal, and suitable for a smartwatch. Avoid complex browsing, too many filters, detailed exploration, or feature-hea

# User Flow/Refined




This refined AI-generated user flow helped clarify the overall logic of the smartwatch concept by turning the earlier sketch explorations into a more structured decision-making sequence. It shows how the experience moves from starting support, to choosing a preference, reviewing suggested songs, deciding whether to save or continue, comparing saved options, and finally confirming the best fit. Compared with the earlier iterations, this version makes the relationship between each step clearer and highlights a smoother, lower-pressure path toward final song selection.